

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

THURSDAY, 17 SEPTEMBER 2026

1 must-know stories, 5 Prelims facts, 7 editorials and 1 explainers, picked from 23 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

International Relations

GS2

MAKE NOTES

Indus Waters Treaty needs modernisation, experts say amid deadlock

On August 31, the Permanent Court of Arbitration — an intergovernmental body headquartered in The Hague — passed an order that said India could not unilaterally retreat from or cast aside the Indus Waters Treaty, a 66-year-old pact governing water sharing between India and Pakistan. India rejected the court's decision shortly after, prolonging the deadlock

Where: Pakistan

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

[Mongabay India: read the source](#)

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

ACT/BILL/RULES

QUICK READ

MEA 'monitoring developments' of Russia sanctions bill in U.S. Congress

The Bill passed by the U.S. House of Representatives authorises the U.S. President to impose tariffs of up to 100% on India and other countries for buying oil and gas from Russia...

[The Hindu: source](#)

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

AGREEMENT/MOU

QUICK READ

Taxman's JAARing move opens fresh debate over Mauritius treaty

The recent invocation of JAAR, a GAAR-type tool in the armoury of the taxman, in a certain case has stunned many. Even though technically the tax department has the power to invoke JAAR, the recent move was entirely unforeseen following the CBDT assurance and subsequent change in the law to spare grandfathered shares from GAAR.

[Economic Times: source](#)

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

ACT/BILL/RULES

QUICK READ

As U.S. readies 100% tariffs, Russia provided more than half of India's oil imports in July

The U.S. House of Representatives passed a Bill on September 16 that seeks to impose tariffs of up to 100% on the top-5 countries absorbing the largest shares of Russia's oil...

[The Hindu: source](#)

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

SPECIES

QUICK READ

High-altitude bird hotspots remain outside protected areas

In the high-altitude landscapes of Himachal Pradesh, conservation efforts have long revolved around the charismatic snow leopard (*Panthera uncia*). But a new study suggests this focus may be leaving a host of other ecologically vital species outside the conservation umbrella. The study, led by scientists from the Nature Conservation Foundation and partner institutions, mapped the

[Mongabay India: source](#)

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY

REPORT/INDEX

QUICK READ

PAC pulls up Railways over gaps in passenger amenities despite promises

Around 96% of stations surveyed had deficient bio-toilets, finds CAG report; panel says Railways ignored observations made since 2007; PAC Chairperson directs Railway Ministry to submit a response within a month...

[The Hindu: source](#)

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS2 Allahabad HC slams UP govt for misusing Goondas Act, warns of damages

The Allahabad High Court criticised the UP government for misusing the Goondas Act. The court noted the law was used for harassment and warned of damages. It also questioned the use of the NSA against a student activist. Procedural shortcuts and executive overreach are becoming systemic issues. Law enforcement must adhere to constitutional rights and due process.

[Economic Times](#)

GS3 Kevin Warsh-led Federal Reserve starts US war on inflation

The US Federal Reserve increased interest rates, signaling a global effort to control rising inflation. Other central banks will likely follow the Fed's lead in this concerted action. Higher global rates and trade friction will impact India's economy and markets. The Indian rupee faces pressure from a strengthening US dollar. Domestic consumption offers some buffer, but inflation concerns persist.

[Economic Times](#)

GS2 China's strategy amid West Asia's security realignment

The Chinese President's visit to Egypt has outlined Beijing's approach

[The Hindu](#)

GS1 Column by Devdutt Pattanaik

Must god represent just one idea? In medieval times, every region and its people had their own versions of the divine

[The Hindu](#)

GS2 Currency conundrum: On the BRICS New Delhi Declaration

Boosting local currency trade in BRICS is not a simple choice for India

[The Hindu](#)

GS2 GS3 Mining amendment is unfair to States

A State that bears the infrastructural and social consequences of mineral extraction must retain a meaningful stake in the economic value generated from its natural resources...

[The Hindu](#)

GS2 All animals need equal consideration

The judiciary's differential treatment of two categories of animals — elephants and street dogs — raises important moral and legal questions...

[The Hindu](#)

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

ED widens scrutiny of possible irregularities in IBC proceedings Enacted in 2016, the Code provides a time-bound framework for resolving insolvency and maximising the value of a distressed company's assets...

[The Hindu](#)

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Supreme Court urges government to make three-language policy mandatory for Class 6 only from January 1, 2027 (Education) [The Hindu](#)
- NITI seeks easier access to geological data, capital for small exploration companies (Governance & Policy) [Economic Times](#)
- Govt denies foreign pressure behind UPI MDR, says charge will help Indian UPI apps (Economy) [The Hindu](#)
- PM Modi highlights India's growing semiconductor ecosystem at SEMICON India 2026 (Science & Technology) [DD News](#)

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 1 must-know, 5 Prelims facts, 4 in the news, 7 editorials, 1 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — International Relations (4), Environment & Ecology (1), Infrastructure & Energy (1). **Nothing today in** — Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy, Social Justice & Welfare, Health, Education, Economy, Agriculture & Allied, Science & Technology, Internal Security, Defence, Disaster Management, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): nothing today · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 1 · Political change in the neighbourhood: nothing today · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: nothing today · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: nothing today

Full text — 0 of 14 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 9, Economic Times 3, Mongabay India 2

Built 04 Oct 2026, 00:10 IST by UPSC Intel. Notes quote the reports; check the source before quoting a figure in an answer.